STAGE GUIDE 03

Create an honest running order

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

Time the whole sequence, including movement, introductions, applause, page changes, and starting notes.

9:40 planned + 0:20 margin = 10:00



Transitions and applause count as real time.

Before you begin

Time the whole sequence, including movement, introductions, applause, page changes, and starting notes. A list of song lengths alone underestimates the event.

Write a usable cue sheet

Use columns for item, duration, leader, starting pitch or accompaniment cue, equipment, and transition. Give every spoken introduction a maximum length and an owner.

Worked ten-minute example

Arrival and settle: 0:30. Introduction: 0:20. Song A: 2:20. Applause and reset: 0:25. Song B: 2:40. Short introduction: 0:20. Song C: 2:35. Final acknowledgement: 0:30. Planned total: 9:40, leaving twenty seconds of margin.

Test the transitions

Practise the final phrase of one item directly into the preparation for the next. Decide whether the choir remains still, changes formation, turns pages, or sits. Give each change enough time.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- ☐ *All items have an owner*
- ☐ *Transitions are included in the timing*
- ☐ *The actual total fits the allotted slot*
- ☐ *There is a small practical timing margin*